QUESTION 1: COMPREHENSION AND LANGUAGE

- **Complete this section in a separate booklet.**

Read **TEXT 1** *"Failure is a Privilege"* by Amy Edmonson and study **TEXT 2** of the insert. Now answer the questions that follow.

1.1	Refer to the title of **TEXT 1** *"Failure is a Privilege"*	
1.1.1	Identify and comment on the effectiveness of the **figure of speech** used in the title.	(2)
1.2	Refer to **paragraph 1.**	
1.2.1	Explain what Billie Jean King means when she says, "Losing a tennis match isn't failure, it's research."	(2)
1.2.2	What are *"intelligent failures"* according to the author? Explain in your own words.	(2)
1.3	Refer to **paragraph 2.**	
1.3.1	Explain the relationship between privilege and failure according to Adam Bradley.	(2)
1.3.2	Read the following sentence: "I want to get to the point where Joe Schmo Black guy is just safe, can be ordinary—even mediocre." Explain the function of the dash used in this sentence.	(1)
1.4	Refer to **paragraph 3.**	
1.4.1	What role do societal biases play in shaping the consequences of failure for minority groups according to the text?	(2)
1.5	Refer to **paragraph 4**	
1.5.1	Write Jennifer Heemstra's words quoted below in reported speech: "I'll say that our responsibility to share our failures is proportional to the amount of power we have in the academic system."	(2)
1.5.2	How does the inclusion of a quote from Jennifer Heemstra position the reader to view the information presented in the paragraph?	(2)
1.6	Refer to **paragraph 5.**	
1.6.1	Analyse the difference between "psychological safety" and "belonging."	(2)
1.7	Critically evaluate the claim that failure is a privilege. Do you agree with this perspective? Provide reasons for your answer.	(3)
1.8		

Refer to **TEXT 1** and **TEXT 2** of the insert and answer the questions which follows.

1.8.1 In what way could the "glass cliff phenomenon" support the views of the writer of Text 1? Support your answer by referring to both texts. (3)

1.8.2 Decide why Carol Bartz would consider it "good" that woman take the chance of being given a position of power when things are going poorly. (2)

[25]

INSERT

TEXT 1: COMPREHENSION PASSAGE

The following passage is adapted from an essay entitled, *Failure is a Privilege* published by *Atria.*

Failure Is a Privilege

By **Amy C. Edmondson**

January 2024

1 Billie Jean King, winner of 39 Grand Slam Tennis titles, said, “Losing a tennis match isn’t failure, it’s research.” Thomas Edison said he hadn’t failed, but rather “found 10,000 ways that don’t work” in his quest to invent a working lightbulb. These game-changing pioneers can praise the benefits of failure all they want. But most of us find failure unpleasant. It helps, I believe, to realise that there is a “right kind of wrong”—a type of failure that brings valuable advances in science, as well as in everyday life. Called “intelligent failures,” these are the undesired results of thoughtful forays into new territory. Intelligent failures illuminate the pathway toward success.

2 Failure can also be a privilege. As journalist and University of Colorado professor Adam Bradley points out “One of the greatest underrecognized privileges of Whiteness might be the licence it gives some to fail without fear.” Bradley explains that being a member of a minority culture often means your failures, especially if they become public, are seen as representative of an entire group. Your individual failure reflects badly on everyone else like you. John Jennings, professor of media and culture studies at the University of California, Riverside, told Bradley, “I want to get to the point where Joe Schmo Black guy is just safe, can be ordinary—even mediocre.”

3 Stereotyping is a natural psychological process that causes people to generalise the actions of an individual to their group. This is especially true when a group is underrepresented in a given field or role. Thus, when a person of colour fails in a consequential role, people tend to overgeneralize, seeing the failure as related to their race rather than to them as an individual. Intuitively aware of this, members of minority groups feel heightened pressure to succeed, so as to avoid triggering these biases—a pressure that ironically inhibits their ability to perform well.

4 Women, especially women in academic science, also lack the luxury of failing unobtrusively. Women are at risk of feeling pressure to succeed at all times lest she spoils other women’s opportunities. Scientist Jennifer Heemstra endorses “a culture in science and academia where people can be open about their failures without consequences.” A realist, she adds, “I’ll say that our responsibility to share our failures is proportional to the amount of power we have in the academic system.”

5 Cultivating psychological safety is not the same thing as cultivating belonging, and many have conflated the two in recent years. Here’s how I see it: Psychological safety, which means believing it’s safe to speak up, is enormously important for feeling a

sense of belonging. But belonging is more personal, while psychological safety is more collective (it is conceptualised in research studies as an emergent property of a group) and, I think, it is co-created by individuals and the groups to which they wish to belong. The more I study the research on the psychology, sociology, and economics of inequality, the more massive the undertaking of correcting these societal failures feels. At the very least, as a society, we should aspire to creating a world where everyone has an equal licence to fail intelligently. That is not the case today. But I believe that we're ever so slightly closer to that aspiration than we were even just a few years ago. Recognizing our heteronormative, white lens through which we view the world is an important first step.

[Source adapted from: https://time.com/6549815/failure-privilege-essay/]

TEXT 2

<u>Why struggling companies promote women: the glass cliff phenomenon</u>

The glass cliff is a relative of the "glass ceiling" — a metaphor for the invisible, societal barrier that keeps women from achieving the highest positions in business, politics, and organisations. The glass cliff is a twist on that: Women are elevated to positions of power when things are going poorly. When they reach the upper ranks of power, they're put into precarious positions and therefore have a higher likelihood of failure, meaning there's a greater risk for them to fall. And it's not just a phenomenon reserved for women; it happens with minority groups, too.

When the going gets rough, organisations look for a change of pace and often believe they find it in someone who isn't their typical executive.

Carol Bartz, once CEO of Yahoo, said it's "good" that women take the chance, as she did, but also acknowledged what often happens next. "It's not that all of a sudden the boards wake up and say, 'Oh, there should be a female here.' They do that sometimes, because it's easier to hide behind, 'Well, of course. Of course that failed, because it was female. What could we have been thinking?'"

[https://www.vox.com/2018/10/31/17960156/what-is-the-glass-cliff-women-ceos]

TEXT 3: SUMMARY PASSAGE

Interview Tips for Teens to Help You Land Your First (or Next) Job

By Alexandra Frost

Updated 9/9/2021

As of July 2021, 36.1% of teens (16 to 19) had a job, according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics—which means that if you're one of the many looking for summer or part-time jobs, you'll need to stand out against the competition to get hired, and an interview is your best chance to impress a hiring-manager.

Researching a company's history and values ahead of time can make or break an interview. Use this knowledge throughout the conversation to demonstrate that you do your homework, and are also a team player with the greater company purpose at heart.

Prepare for Common Interview Questions. These will vary based on the field, but your future boss wants to see you are responsible and respectful, and that you're able to fulfil all the job requirements. Tell Me About Yourself. This seems like informal small talk, but it's actually your opportunity to humbly brag about everything you want them to know. What Questions Do You Have for Us? You can bet few teens have prepared for this part of the interview, and the questions you ask just might ensure you get hired. You can prepare for interviews by practising with a friend, parent or teacher (Note: This is the only step where parents should be involved.)

Dress the Part. This will mean different things for different positions. If you're interviewing for a law firm internship, a suit and tie would be completely appropriate. But the same outfit worn to a fast-food restaurant interview could seem out of place. Consider the attire your future boss might wear, and try to match the formality of that.

The interview process doesn't end with that final handshake (which should be strong and confident, by the way). Instead, follow up with a short and heartfelt thank you note. Try to be polite and limit your follow-up to one sincere gesture or check-in. If you find out you didn't get it, ask, "Is there any feedback you can provide so I can improve?" Either way, don't be discouraged, there will be other positions.

TEXT 4: SUMMARY VISUAL



TEXT 5: UNSEEN POETRY

A Wish for my Children

(Evangeline Paterson)

On this doorstep I stand
year after year
to watch you going

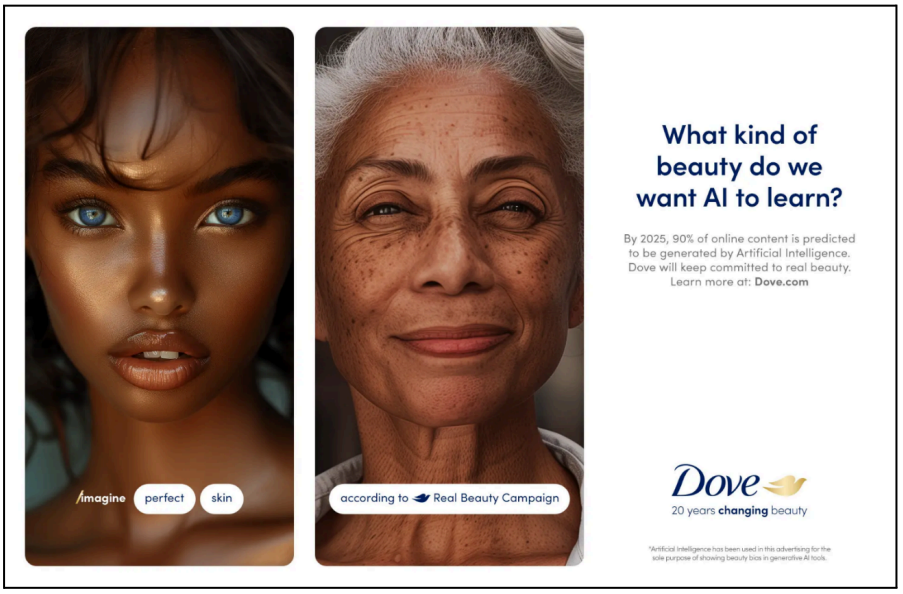
and think: May you not
skin your knees. May you
not catch your fingers
in car doors. May
your hearts not break.

May tide and weather
wait for your coming

and may you grow strong
to break
all webs of my weaving.

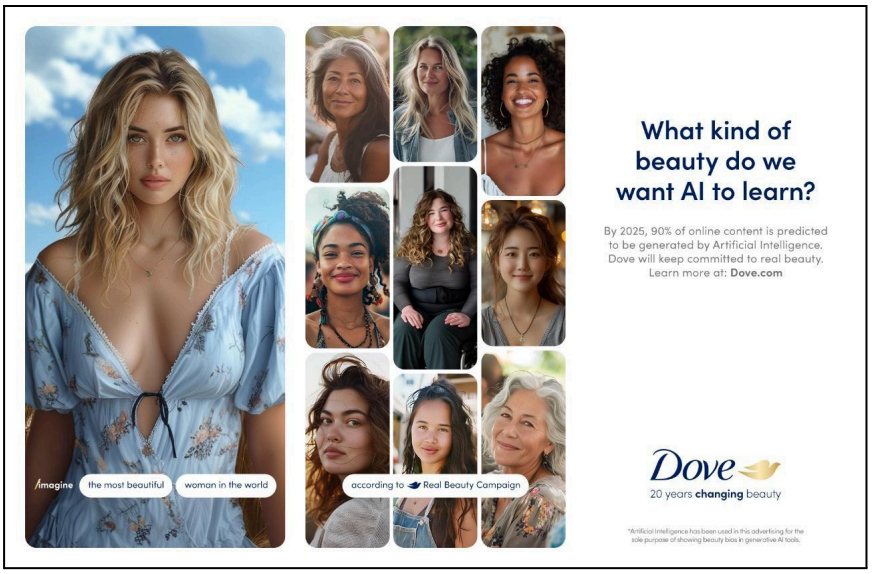
VISUAL LITERACY

TEXT 6



Source: *Adsoftheworld.com*

TEXT 7



Source: *Adsoftheworld.com*

The text from **TEXT 6** and **TEXT 7** reads as follows:

What kind of beauty do we want AI to learn?

By 2025, 90% of online content is predicted to be generated by Artificial Intelligence. Dove will keep committed to real beauty. Learn more at: Dove.com

*Artificial Intelligence has been used in this advert for the sole purpose of showing beauty bias in generative AI tools.

TEXT 8

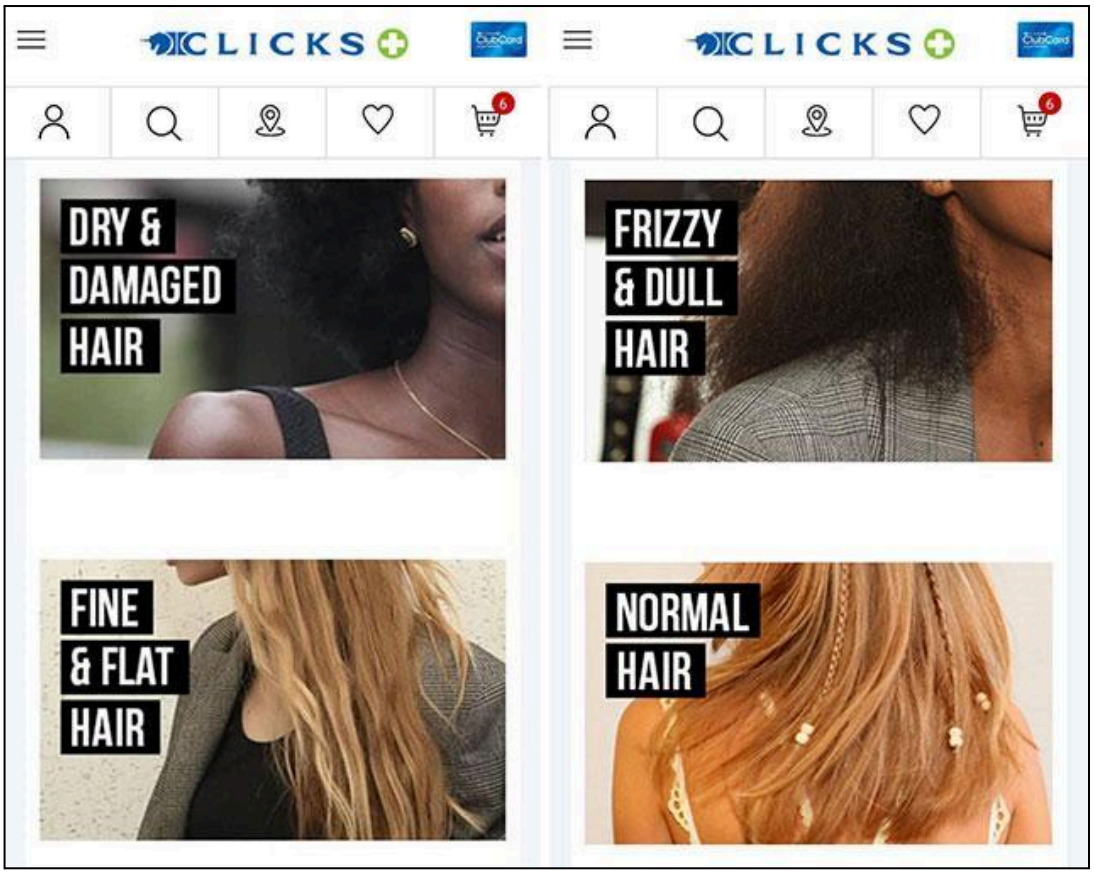


TEXT FROM **TEXT 8** READS AS FOLLOWS:

Visibly more beautiful skin from the most unexpected of places – your shower.

Introducing Dove VisibleCare, our new revolutionary line of body washes that actually improves the look of your skin. With our highest concentration of NutriumMoisture™, you'll see visibly more beautiful skin in just one week. NEW DOVE VISIBLECARE CRÈME BODY WASH.

TEXT 9



TEXT 10:

implicit bias (noun): attitudes or stereotypes that people associate with a particular group without realising. These biases can affect how people think about or treat others, even if they don't mean to.

COMPREHENSION AND LANGUAGE

Read **TEXT 1** *"Failure is a Privilege"* by Amy Edmonson and study **TEXT 2** of the insert. Now answer the questions that follow.

1.1 Refer to the title of TEXT 1 *"Failure is a Privilege"*

1.1.1 Identify and comment on the effectiveness of the **figure of speech** used in the title. (2)

Metaphor.Comparing failure to a privilege. Failure is typically seen as something to avoid, a sign of inadequacy or weakness. By framing it as a privilege, the metaphor pushes readers to reconsider their assumptions about failure and success, highlighting that not everyone has equal opportunities to fail and recover.

1.2 Refer to **paragraph 1.**

1.2.1 Explain what Billie Jean King means when she says, "Losing a tennis match isn't failure, it's research." (2)

King means that losing is part of the learning process, and each loss helps improve her future performance. The use of the word "research" implies that King is simply gathering information that will be used to help her do better in future.

1.2.2 What are *"intelligent failures"* according to the author? Explain in your own words. (2)

"Intelligent failures" are thoughtful mistakes made while exploring new territory, leading to valuable learning or progress.

1.3. Refer to **paragraph 2.**

1.3.1 Explain the relationship between privilege and failure according to Adam Bradly. (2)

The more privilege a person has, the more allowances they have to fail with little negative consequences. According to Bradley, certain people, especially those from dominant or privileged groups, can fail without worrying that their failures will reflect poorly on their entire race or community.

1.3.2 Read the following sentence: "I want to get to the point where Joe Schmo Black guy is just safe, can be ordinary—even mediocre." Identify and explain the punctuation mark used in this sentence. (1)

(Em) dash(a long dash), used to introduce extra information such as examples. In this sentence the em dash is used to emphasise that black men should be able to only be ordinary but also be mediocre.

1.4 Refer to **paragraph 3.**

1.4.1 What role do societal biases play in shaping the consequences of failure for minority groups according to the text? (2)

Societal biases can cause individuals from minority groups to feel extra pressure not to fail because their failures are often overgeneralized and attributed to their race or gender, not to individual circumstances.

1.5. Refer to **paragraph 4.**

1.5.1 Write Jennifer Heemstra's words quoted below in reported speech:
"Our responsibility to share our failures is proportional to the amount of power we have in the academic system." (2)

Jennifer Heemstra said that their responsibility to share their failures was proportional to the amount of power they had in the academic system.

1.5.2 How does the inclusion of a quote from Jennifer Heemstra position the reader to view the information presented in the paragraph? (2)
JH is a scientist, with vast knowledge and superior abilities of analysis. Including a quote from a well educated woman in an article about allowing people from less privileged groups to fail, positions the reader to trust the information about the difficulties women in science face regarding the ability of women in science to fail.

1.6. Refer to **paragraph 5.**

(2)

1.6.1 Analyse the difference between "psychological safety" and "belonging."
Psychological safety refers to the belief that it is safe to speak up or make mistakes within a group, while belonging is a personal feeling of acceptance within that group. Psychological safety focuses on the group while belonging is more personal and refers to how the individual feels within a group.

1.7. Critically **evaluate** the claim that failure is a privilege. Do you agree with this perspective? Provide reasons for your answer. (2)

Answers will vary. Example: "I agree because societal privileges often determine the consequences of failure. Privileged groups can afford to fail, while others may face significant setbacks. Certain people get to 'fail up' and are rewarded for failing while others are not. E.g Trump.

1.8 Refer to **TEXT 1** and **TEXT 2** of your insert and answer the question which follows.

1.8.1 In what way could the "glass cliff phenomenon" support the views of the writer of Text 1? Support your answer by referring to both texts. (3)
The glass cliff occurs when companies set women up to fail by promoting women into positions of power when companies are performing poorly. This sets women up because when the company fails, the woman leadership and her identity is blamed for the expected weak outcome. Text 1 refers to how the ability to fail is a privilege, this means that when women or minorities are given positions of power, their failures are seen as being due to their identity as opposed to being part of the normal part of learning how to manage organisations.

1.8.2

Decide why Carol Bartz would consider it “good” that women take the chance of being given a position of power when things are going poorly. (2)

Carol Bartz considers it good that women should take a chance and ascend to power because even though she may be being set up to fail, the woman leader will gain invaluable experience, she will learn the lessons that come with holding that position of power.